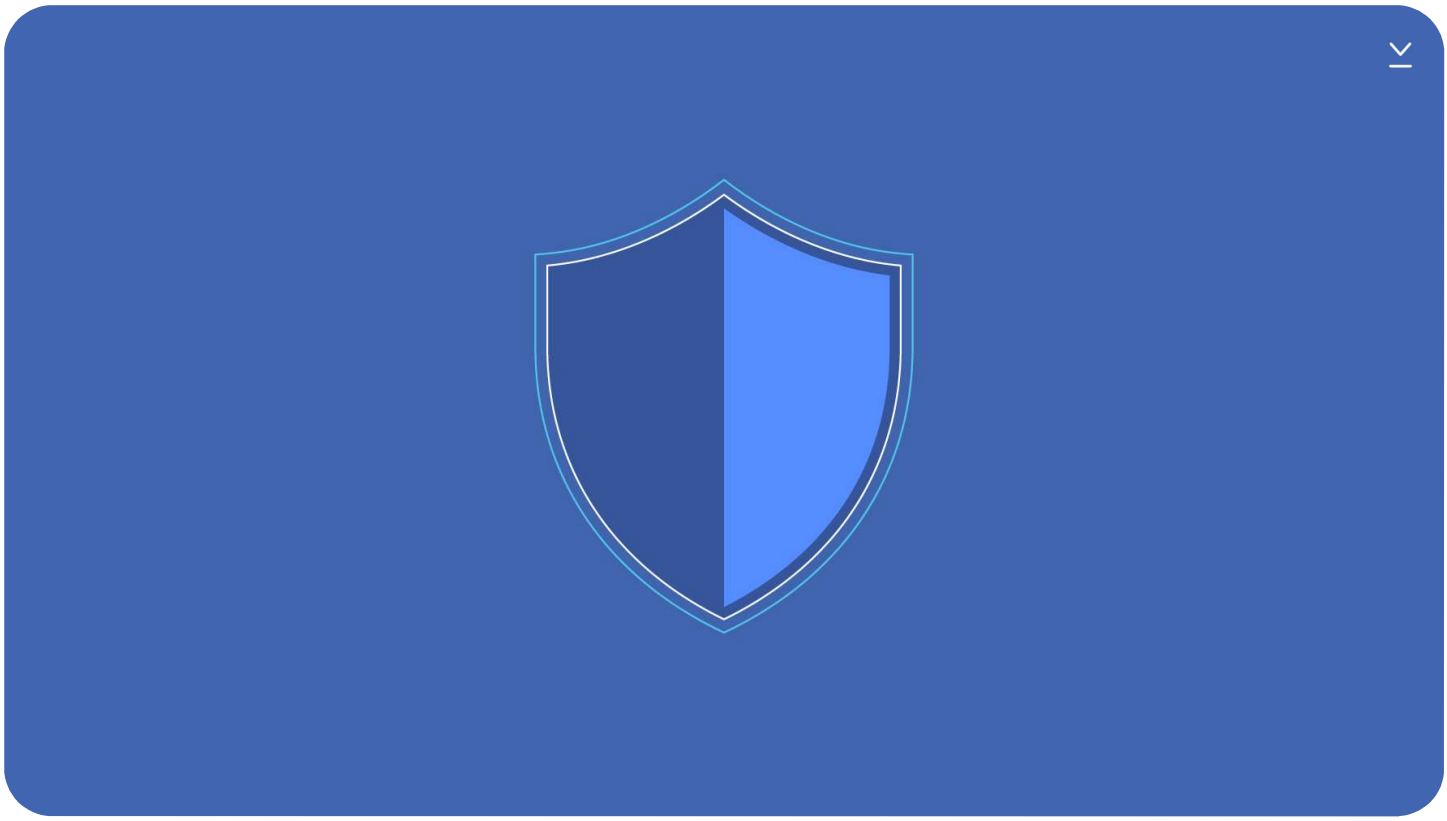
Back to Newsroom

META

Removing Coordinated Inauthentic Behavior From the Philippines

March 28, 2019

LISTEN TO ARTICLE



By Nathaniel Gleicher, Head of Cybersecurity Policy

Today we removed 200 Pages, Groups and accounts that engaged in coordinated inauthentic behavior on Facebook and Instagram in the Philippines, misleading others about who they were and what they were doing.

We are constantly working to detect and stop this type of activity because we don't want our services to be used to manipulate people. We're taking down these Pages and accounts based on their behavior, not the content they posted. In this case, the people behind this activity coordinated with one another and used fake accounts to misrepresent themselves, and that was the basis for our action.

While we are making progress rooting out this abuse, as we've said before, it's an ongoing challenge and we constantly have to improve to stay ahead. That means building better technology, hiring more people and working more closely with law enforcement, security experts and other companies.

We'll update this post with more details when we have them, or if the facts change.

What We've Found So Far

The individuals behind this activity used a combination of authentic and fake accounts to disseminate content across a variety of Pages and Groups. They frequently posted about local and political news, including topics like the upcoming elections, candidate updates and views, alleged misconduct of political opponents, and controversial events that were purported to occur during previous administrations. Although the people behind this activity attempted to conceal their identities, our investigation found that this activity was linked to a network organized by Nic Gabunada.

- *Presence on Facebook and Instagram:* 67 Pages, 68 Facebook accounts, 40 Groups and 25 Instagram accounts.
- *Followers:* About 3.6 million accounts followed one or more of these Pages, about 1.8 million accounts joined at least one of these Groups and around 5,300 accounts followed one or more of these Instagram accounts.
- *Advertising:* Around 59,000 USD in spending for ads on Facebook paid for in Philippine peso, Saudi riyal and US dollars. The first ad ran in January 2014 and the most recent ad ran in March 2019.

We identified these accounts and Pages through an ongoing internal investigation into Philippines-linked coordinated inauthentic behavior. Our assessment benefited from open source reporting. We have shared relevant information with policymakers and industry partners.

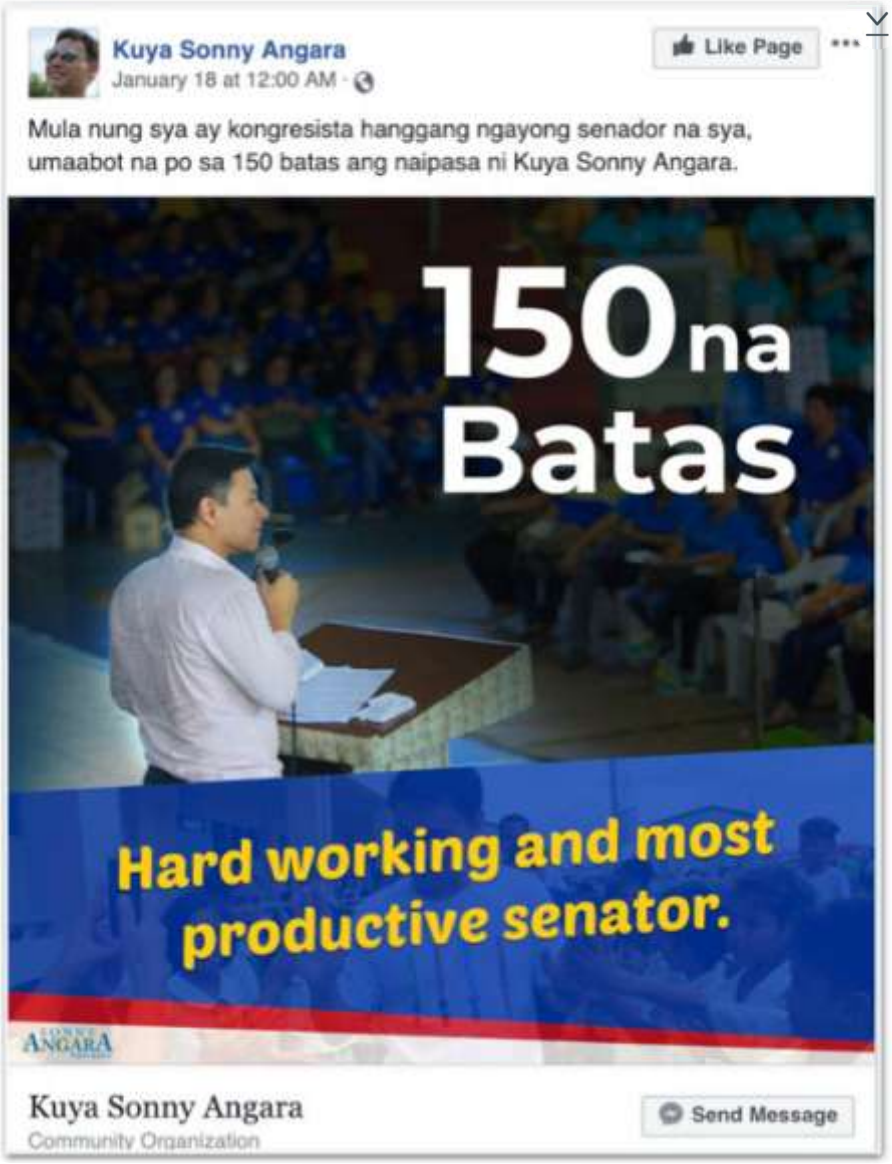
Below is a sample of the content posted by some of these Pages:

Caption: DU30 blessed us again! MRT has new air conditioner units! It's now gonna be cold in the Philippines!
Photo text: "Comfortable Life for all"

Caption: Husband and his wife that allegedly has 4 lovers, confront each other on Tulfo's program. Watch the intense confrontation of the two here. Please spread.

Caption: The fountains are so beautiful

Caption: Apparently it’s possible for a man to give birth through Cesarian or C-section. How did this happen? Find out!



Caption: Since the time he was a congressman and now that he is a senator, Kuya Sonny Angara has passed 150 laws.

Categories: Integrity and Security, Meta

Tags: Coordinated Inauthentic Behavior, Security News

DOWNLOAD ALL IMAGES

Share this article

RECENT NEWS

WhatsApp Adds New Features to Simplify Storage, Switch Accounts, and More

Meta Partners With Arm to Develop New Class of Data Center Silicon

Boosting Your Support and Safety on Meta's Apps With AI

Creator Fast Track: A New Way to Quickly Grow Your Audience and Earn Money on Facebook

RELATED NEWS

FACEBOOK

Cracking Down on Spammy Content on Facebook

April 24, 2025

META

Taking Action Against 'Nudify' Apps

June 12, 2025

Follow Meta Newsroom |

Press Resources | PRESS@META.COM MEDIA GALLERY

Meta

Meta Store

Community

Our actions

About us

Site terms and policies

App support

© 2026 Meta

Community Standards Data Policy Terms Cookie policy

United States

(English)